

Caroline Edwards

Product Designer | Simplifying digital journeys | Building trust through accessible design

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Product Designer who turns difficult digital journeys into services people can navigate with confidence. I've led UX across publishing and public-sector platforms for Centaur Media, Macmillan, EMAP, Condé Nast, Lincolnshire and Isle of Anglesey County Councils, combining research, accessibility and product thinking to make complex experiences simpler, clearer and more useful.

Good design starts with understanding people, not just their data

CORE SKILLS

User Research & Synthesis	User Flows	Inclusive & SEND-Informed Design
Usability Testing	Wireframing & Prototyping	Design Systems & Components
Evidence-Based Design	Mobile & Native App Design	Stakeholder Collaboration
Service Design & Journey Mapping	Interface Design	Workshop Facilitation
Design QA & Developer Handoff	Accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA & 2.2)	Agile Product Delivery
Interaction Design	Information Architecture	Ethical AI-Assisted Design

RECENT PROJECTS

Private Healthcare (NDA) | Redesigned a high-stakes patient appointment journey through research, journey mapping, prototyping and usability testing.

HabitHero | Ran three rounds of usability testing to refine a healthcare mobile product, then developed a 20+ screen design system for developer handoff.

Arbor (Self-initiated) | Used interviews, heuristic evaluation and usability testing to identify and redesign the information architecture behind school event ticket purchasing.

EXPERIENCE

Product Designer

King's College London. February 2026 - Present

- Led end-to-end product design from discovery through interactive prototype, using research, testing and stakeholder input to identify and prioritise the problems worth solving.
- Planned and conducted user interviews, usability testing, heuristic evaluations and stakeholder workshops, using findings to challenge assumptions and refine journeys.
- Translated research findings into user flows, information architecture and accessible interaction patterns, applying WCAG principles throughout the design process.

- Built reusable Figma components, design patterns and interaction models to improve consistency across screens and support clearer developer handoff.
- Balanced user needs with business objectives and technical constraints, using research and testing evidence to prioritise design decisions.

SEND Experience Support (Applied Inclusive Design)

Hampshire County Council. July 2021 - Present

- Work directly with children with autism, SEND and complex behavioural needs, observing how they interact with digital learning tools in real classroom conditions rather than relying on assumptions about how they should work.
- Identify barriers by observing behaviour, communication and workarounds, then adapt information, interactions and support around the individual's needs.
- Translate complex individual needs into structured support plans in collaboration with teachers, SENCOs, therapists and families, balancing different perspectives to create a consistent approach.
- Adapt communication, information and support in response to observed behaviour, giving me first-hand experience of how accessibility needs can differ from assumptions made in designed systems.

Service Designer & Operations Lead

Everybody Pilates. March 2016 – August 2021

- Grew membership by 150% and annual revenue to over £100k by identifying friction across the customer journey and redesigning key service experiences around member needs.
- Mapped customer journeys alongside staff and member feedback to identify gaps between the intended service and what was actually happening across four locations.
- Turned staff ideation and customer insight into standardised service processes, training materials and operational guidance, making the experience more consistent as the business grew.
- Mentored a direct team of six and staff across franchise locations, helping teams adopt new processes and maintain consistent service delivery.

Lead Interaction Designer

Abacus e-Media. August 2006 – May 2016

Progressed from Junior to Lead Interaction Designer over nearly a decade at an award-winning digital agency, working across education, publishing, public sector, B2B and B2C products.

- Led UX, interaction and visual design from discovery through delivery across content-heavy websites, SaaS products and digital services, balancing user needs with commercial and technical requirements.
- Designed across multiple publishing brands, audiences and business models, balancing editorial, commercial and technical requirements while maintaining a consistent experience across devices.
- Designed reusable interaction patterns and shared design systems across client platforms to create consistency across new builds and reduce repeated design work.

- Found a council recruitment form that couldn't be completed using a keyboard alone, then worked directly with the developer to rebuild the interaction, making controls reachable and operable in sequence with visible focus at every step, meeting WCAG Keyboard and Focus Order criteria.
- Replaced an entirely paper-based recruitment process for Derbyshire County Council, reducing a two-week delay before applications reached managers, moving 60% of the council's 5,000 annual vacancies online and saving close to £190,000 a year.
- Mentored junior designers while helping establish the studio's approach to UX, accessibility and design standards.

Recognition: Contributed to seven industry award-winning projects, including Government Website of the Year and multiple PPA and AOP award-winners.

Interactive Learning Designer

BBC. July 2005 – September 2005

Contributed to **BBC Jam**, designing interactive numeracy content for children aged 5-7. Worked with educators and curriculum specialists to translate curriculum objectives into engaging and accessible digital learning experiences.

Interactive Designer

Big Pink. May 2005 – July 2005

Designed digital experiences for healthcare organisations including **GSK and Pfizer**, translating complex medical information into intuitive, accessible websites and interactive campaigns. Worked with creative, technical and client teams within highly regulated environments.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

E-Commerce Innovation of the Year (2013) PPA Customer Direct Awards - The Grocer, William Reed Business Media | Lead UX/UI Designer

Digital Innovation of the Year (2013) PPA Awards TES Connect, TSL Education | UX/UI Designer

Digital Data Product of the Year (2012) PPA Awards - TES Connect, TSL Education | UX/UI Designer

Government Website of the Year (2011) - Lincolnshire County Council | Lead UX/UI Designer

IT Project Innovation Award (2011) - Lincs to the Past | Lead Designer

IT Project Innovation Award (2009) - C4YP | Lead Designer

Business Website of the Year AOP Awards (2009) TES Connect, TSL Education | UX/UI Designer

EDUCATION

Interactive Media Production BA (Hons) | Bournemouth University 2003 - 2006

Computer Animation & Visualisation Foundation | Bournemouth University 2002 - 2003

Graphic Design BTEC Diploma | Reading College 2001 - 2002